

# Week 8 — Diagnosis by Hearing & Smelling

聞診

EAM310 · EAST ASIAN MEDICINE DIAGNOSIS I · VUIM SUMMER 2026

⚠ Quiz 6 — September 4, 2026

Class: Friday September 4, 2026 · 9AM–1PM

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## REQUIRED READINGS — DUE BEFORE SEPTEMBER 4

### FCM CHAPTER 26 — MACIOCIA

- Diagnosis by Hearing & Smelling — full chapter
- 聞 Wén — same character means both "hear" and "smell"
- Hearing: voice, breathing, cough, vomit, hiccup, borborygmi, sighing, belching
- Smelling: body odour + odour of bodily secretions
- General rule: Loud=Full · Weak=Empty · Foul=Heat · Absent=Cold

### SCHRIER LECTURE SLIDES — WK 9 FILE (THIS CONTENT = WEEK 8)

- Voice-Zang Fu relationship (Lung/Kidney/SP-ST)
- Five Element sounds — detailed clinical descriptions
- Six Healing Sounds (Qigong) — bonus/supplementary
- Five Element odors — sensory descriptions with pinyin
- Odors of nose, ears, eyes — supplementary to FCM

## WEEK 8 LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Apply the general hearing rule: loud=Full/Heat, weak=Empty/Cold
- Map the 5 voice sounds to their organs (shout/laugh/sing/weep/groan)
- Differentiate Full vs Empty presentations of cough, hiccup, belching, vomiting
- Interpret odor of breath, sweat, sputum, stool, urine, vaginal discharge
- Apply the general smelling rule: foul=Heat, absent=Cold
- Map the 5 body/breath odors to their organs (rancid → putrid)
- Interpret abnormal respiration (asthma, wheezing, panting, SOB)
- Recognize when body-odor/constitution mismatch is a worse prognostic sign

## ASSESSMENT CALENDAR

| Date   | Event                 | Material Covered                                       |
|--------|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Aug 28 | Week 7 Class          | Diagnosis by Inquiry + Palpation                       |
| Sep 4  | ⚠ Quiz 6              | Diagnosis by Hearing & Smelling — voice, sounds, odors |
| Sep 11 | FINAL + Journal 26–50 | Weeks 6–9 comprehensive                                |

## IN-CLASS PRACTICE — WHAT TO EXPECT

### LISTENING & SMELLING PRACTICE LAB

Week 8 includes partner practice on auditory/olfactory diagnosis. Come ready to:

- Listen to a partner's speaking voice — assess volume, Five-Element tonal quality
- Practice distinguishing loud vs weak sounds across cough, breathing, belching
- Discuss body odor as a constitutional Five-Element indicator (non-invasive, verbal report is fine)
- Document a case in your Journal integrating hearing/smelling findings with tongue/pulse

聞 Wén — the same Chinese character means both "to hear" and "to smell." Both are used together as ONE of the Four Diagnostic Pillars.

DIAGNOSIS BY HEARING — WHAT WE LISTEN FOR

|                              |                                                           |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| First — listen to changes in | Speech and breathing; volume, strength, clarity, and rate |
| Second — listen for          | "Abnormal" sounds: coughing, sneezing, belching, etc.     |

**General principle:** A LOUD sound indicates a Full/Heat pattern. A WEAK sound indicates an Empty/Cold pattern. This single rule underlies all of listening diagnosis — voice, breathing, cough, vomiting, hiccup, borborygmi, and more.

VOICE — ZANG-FU RELATIONSHIPS

| Organ            | Relationship to the Voice                                                                                                                       |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Lung             | The gateway of the voice — helps create sounds through the movement of Qi. The <i>production</i> of sound is directly related to this organ.    |
| Kidney           | The root of the voice — controls the root of Yuan Qi and the reception of Qi. The <i>volume</i> of the voice is directly related to this organ. |
| Spleen & Stomach | The acquired root of Qi — influences vocalization. The <i>strength</i> of the voice is directly related to these organs.                        |

VOICE — QUICK REFERENCE

|                       |                                    |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------|
| Loud voice            | Full or Heat pattern               |
| Weak voice            | Empty or Cold pattern              |
| Weak and vague        | Exterior Wind-Cold, or Dampness    |
| Reluctance to talk    | Cold pattern or Lung-Qi deficiency |
| Excessive talking     | Heat                               |
| Sudden loss of voice  | Invasion of exterior Wind-Heat     |
| Gradual loss of voice | Lung-Qi or Lung-Yin deficiency     |

ABNORMAL VOCALIZATIONS — HOARSENESS

|                                                 |                                |
|-------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Sudden onset, low pitch, raspy                  | Exterior syndrome              |
| Chronic, gradual intensity                      | Blood stagnation               |
| Hoarseness + plum-pit sensation + cough         | Phlegm-Heat                    |
| Chronic, gradually increasing, worse in evening | Lung and Kidney Yin deficiency |

FIVE ELEMENT SOUNDS — MASTER TABLE

| Sound / Element                | Clinical Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Shouting</b> 呼 hū / Wood    | Gives forcefulness to the voice; an indication of assertion. When one shouts they want to be heard and/or are asking, explicitly or implicitly, for changes to be made. Frequently becomes louder at moments when the person is not really needing to be assertive. |
| <b>Laughter</b> 笑 xiào / Fire  | Occurs when expressing moments of joy. Does not necessarily mean an actual belly laugh — can include a "pre-laugh" without an actual laugh emerging. Fire is a very Yang Element, so just as laughter rises upwards/outwards, so does this sound.                   |
| <b>Singing</b> 唱 chàng / Earth | May occur naturally when singing a lullaby with a child in arms, or soothing an anxious/distressed animal or person. Has increased variation in pitch — the voice goes up and down more frequently.                                                                 |
| <b>Weeping</b> / Metal         | Consumes or dissolves Qi. More of a non-verbal sound, based on an expressive emotional quality. When a person speaks with a weep they might easily begin to cry; other times there could be a choking back or faltering in the words.                               |
| <b>Groaning</b> / Water        | Has little movement or modulation in quality — a flatness, as if the more normal ups and downs of the voice have been squeezed or flattened out.                                                                                                                    |

**Clinical use:** These are not just diagnostic labels — listen for HOW a patient speaks, not just what they say. A patient who shouts unnecessarily during a calm conversation reveals Liver disharmony independent of their words.

VOICE & ZANG-FU — QUICK MATCH REFERENCE

|          |                |
|----------|----------------|
| Shouting | Liver / Wood   |
| Laughing | Heart / Fire   |
| Singing  | Spleen / Earth |
| Weepy    | Lung / Metal   |
| Groaning | Kidney / Water |

USING SOUNDS AS HEALING — THE SIX HEALING SOUNDS 六字訣

A Qigong practice using specific sounds/breaths to affect corresponding organs — supplementary context for how the diagnostic sounds connect to therapeutic sound.

|        |                                                                                                   |
|--------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 噓 Xū   | Affects the Liver — helps remove Heat, disperses blockages, brings brightness to the eyes         |
| 呵 Hē   | Affects the Heart — expels Heat, makes Qi descend, reduces Fire in the Heart                      |
| 呼 Hū   | Affects the Spleen — helps drive out Heat and strengthens the Spleen in all four seasons          |
| 咽 Sì   | Affects the Lung — moderates stress, calms Qi, moistens the Lungs                                 |
| 吹 Chuī | Affects the Kidneys — removes Wind and Cold, urges stagnant Qi, brings tranquility                |
| 嘻 Xī   | Affects the Triple Burner — clears Heat and restlessness, drives out strong emotional afflictions |

| Breathing — Quick Reference                          |                                                    |
|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Coarse, loud breathing                               | Full pattern                                       |
| Weak, thin breathing                                 | Empty pattern                                      |
| Deep breathing                                       | Excess Qi in the Heart and Lungs                   |
| Weak breathing                                       | Deficiency of Qi in Liver and Kidney               |
| Rough respiration, rapid inhalation, slow exhalation | Heat, excess, exogenous condition                  |
| Faint respiration, slow inhalation and exhalation    | Deficiency condition or chronic internal condition |

| Respiration — Excess vs Empty Patterns |                                                                                                                                                                        |
|----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Pattern                                | Presentation                                                                                                                                                           |
| Excess and/or Heat patterns            | Sound of respiration is loud, breath rough and distressed, acute onset. Seen in surplus of external contraction of pathogenic factor or Phlegm-Heat invading the Lung. |
| Empty and/or Cold patterns             | Sound of respiration is low, breath faint and slow, disease onset relatively slow. Seen in internal damage causing insufficient Zheng Qi and Kidney/Lung-Qi vacuity.   |

| Panting — Excess vs Deficiency                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Rapid, irregular respiration, extreme to the point that the nostrils move, with uneven entrance/exit of breath, opening of the mouth, raising of the shoulders, and difficulty lying down. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Excess                                                                                                                                                                                     | Respiration irregular, chest is full, sound is loud, breath is rough, exit of breath is irregular and exhalation uneven — Xie Qi (pathogenic Qi) obstructing the Lung                                                                       |
| Deficiency                                                                                                                                                                                 | Respiration irregular, breath timid, voice low, inhalation diminished and exhalation increased, breath not continuous, panting more severe with movement — Kidney deficiency (unable to absorb Qi) or Lung deficiency (unable to govern Qi) |

| Abnormal Respiration — By Type |                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Asthma                         | Lung-Qi's failure to descend                                                    |
| Wheezing                       | Lung-Qi fails to descend with Phlegm obstruction                                |
| Upper Stifling                 | Lung-Qi rises upward to the throat and obstructs the air tract                  |
| Shortness of Breath            | Lung-Qi deficiency, or Water Retention in the Chest (coughing up watery sputum) |
| Shortage of Qi                 | Lung-Qi obstructed, Lung-Qi deficiency, or Zheng Qi insufficient                |

| COUGH 咳嗽 KÉ SÒU                                                                                                     |                                                                                           |                                                                                       |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Due to the Lung not diffusing and down-bearing, Lung-Qi rising counterflow, and Phlegm and Qi flooding the airways. |                                                                                           |                                                                                       |
| Loud, explosive cough                                                                                               | Full pattern                                                                              |                                                                                       |
| Weak cough                                                                                                          | Empty pattern                                                                             |                                                                                       |
| Dry cough                                                                                                           | Lung-Yin deficiency                                                                       |                                                                                       |
| Sound without phlegm                                                                                                | "Unproductive cough"                                                                      |                                                                                       |
| Phlegm with sound                                                                                                   | "Productive cough"                                                                        |                                                                                       |
| SNEEZING                                                                                                            |                                                                                           |                                                                                       |
| Acute onset, constant loud sounds                                                                                   | Heat and/or excess condition                                                              |                                                                                       |
| Chronic, frequent, soft in volume                                                                                   | Lung-Qi deficiency                                                                        |                                                                                       |
| Sudden sneezing in critical stage of chronic illness                                                                | Yang-Qi recovery                                                                          |                                                                                       |
| Sneezing due to external stimulation                                                                                | Normal                                                                                    |                                                                                       |
| VOMITING, HICCUP & BELCHING                                                                                         |                                                                                           |                                                                                       |
| Type                                                                                                                | Full/Excess                                                                               | Empty/Deficiency                                                                      |
| Vomiting                                                                                                            | Sudden onset, retching loud/forceful — frequently Stomach-Heat                            | Slow onset, retching low/faint/without force — frequently Stomach deficiency and Cold |
| Hiccup                                                                                                              | Loud sound — often Liver-Qi invading Stomach                                              | Quiet, low sound — often Stomach-Qi or Stomach-Yin deficiency                         |
| Belching                                                                                                            | Loud and long sound — retention of food, Stomach-Heat, or Liver-Qi invading Stomach       | Short and low sound — Stomach-Qi deficiency or Stomach-Qi deficiency with Cold        |
| VOMITING, BELCHING & HICCUP — ALL REBELLIOUS STOMACH-QI                                                             |                                                                                           |                                                                                       |
| Symptom                                                                                                             | Mechanism                                                                                 |                                                                                       |
| Vomiting                                                                                                            | Food, fluid, or sputum flows up from the Stomach and out of the mouth with sound          |                                                                                       |
| Belching                                                                                                            | Air or gas flows up from the stomach and makes sound passing through the throat           |                                                                                       |
| Hiccup                                                                                                              | Stomach-Qi's rebellion causes involuntary spasms of the diaphragm and makes a short sound |                                                                                       |

BORBORYGMI (GURGLING SOUND IN THE INTESTINES)

|                                              |                                                                                                                             |
|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Loud sound (usually with diarrhea/dysentery) | Full pattern — Cold-Damp in Middle Burner, Phlegm-Damp in MB, Liver/Spleen disharmony, or Damp-Heat in Stomach & Intestines |
| Low sound                                    | Empty pattern — Spleen/Kidney-Yang deficiency, or Middle Burner Qi deficiency                                               |

YAWNING

|                                                                      |                               |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Frequent, loud, relieved after yawn, induced by emotional changes    | Liver-Qi Stagnation           |
| Accompanied by chest pain, may occur after injury or chronic illness | Blood and Qi Stagnation       |
| Infrequent attack, weak or no sound                                  | Spleen/Kidney-Yang Deficiency |

SIGHING

|                                                                                                                        |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Generally indicates Qi stagnation of the Liver or Lungs, often from emotional problems                                 |
| Liver involved: repressed anger or frustration                                                                         |
| Lungs involved: worry and sadness                                                                                      |
| Weak sound sighing may also be due to deficiency of the Spleen and Heart, deriving from sadness, grief, or pensiveness |

**Integration principle:** Borborygmi, yawning, and sighing all follow the same Full/Empty logic as every other hearing-diagnosis sign — but each carries a distinct organ signature (Intestines/SP-KD for borborygmi, LV-Qi stagnation for yawning, LV/LU-Qi stagnation for sighing). Cross-reference with the patient's emotional history for confirmation.

DIAGNOSIS BY SMELLING — TWO ASPECTS

|        |                                                                                                                                 |
|--------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| First  | The odor of the patient's body itself — gives insight into both the pattern of disharmony AND the patient's constitutional type |
| Second | The odor of certain bodily secretions — used only to identify the prevailing pattern of disharmony                              |

**General rule:** Any strong and/or foul smell is indicative of **Heat**. Absence of smell is indicative of **Cold**. Smelling is not usually a clinching diagnostic factor — mostly used to confirm the main pattern already suspected from other signs.

BODY ODOR — CONSTITUTIONAL VS PATHOLOGICAL

|                                                                                                            |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Body odors are detected mostly when the patient undresses, especially on the back                          |
| In the absence of a disharmony, body odor reflects the patient's <b>constitutional</b> Five-Element type   |
| Body odor can ALSO reflect current patterns of disharmony — which may NOT match the patient's Element type |

**Key clinical principle:** If body odor CONTRADICTS the constitutional Element type, this is a BAD sign. It is WORSE for a Wood type to have a scorched (Fire) odor than an exaggerated rancid (Wood) one — the mismatch reveals a disharmony outside the person's own baseline organ system.

FIVE-ELEMENT ODORS — DETAILED SENSORY REFERENCE

| Odor / Element                           | Sensory Description                                                                                                                                                                              |
|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Rancid</b> 餿 sōu / Wood               | Associated with fat that's no longer fresh or slightly sour; related to newly mown grass but not pleasant. Effect on the inside of the nose is somewhat prickling, makes one wrinkle their nose. |
| <b>Scorched</b> 焦 / Fire                 | Resembles burnt toast, clothes just out of the tumble dryer, or a shirt scorched while ironing.                                                                                                  |
| <b>Fragrant/Sweetish</b> 香 xiāng / Earth | NOT a pleasing floral smell — the opposite. More associated with a cloying, sickly-sweet quality with a tendency to linger in the nostrils.                                                      |
| <b>Rotten</b> 爛 làn / Metal              | Fills the inside of the nose with tiny prickles, may make one clench the inside of their nose. Rotting meat / trash can / garbage truck is the best verbal description.                          |
| <b>Putrid</b> 腐 fǔ / Water               | The smell of rotting meat; can also describe stagnant pond water or stale urine. Has a sharp, aggressive quality that makes one's nose clench up.                                                |

HEAT VS COLD — GENERAL ODOR CHARACTER

|                   |                               |
|-------------------|-------------------------------|
| Heat or Excess    | Foul, rotten, fetid, stinking |
| Cold or Deficient | Fishy or odorless             |

| BODY ODOR — SPECIFIC PRESENTATIONS                                                                                                          |                                                          |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Goatish odor                                                                                                                                | Wind, Damp, Heat accumulation                            |
| Foul stinking                                                                                                                               | Epidemic infectious disease, or Summer-Heat toxin        |
| Foul set in the armpit                                                                                                                      | Damp-Heat accumulation                                   |
| BREATH                                                                                                                                      |                                                          |
| Strong, foul                                                                                                                                | Stomach-Heat or retention of food                        |
| Sour                                                                                                                                        | Retention of food; Accumulation Disorder (in children)   |
| Foul, pungent                                                                                                                               | Damp-Heat in Stomach and Spleen                          |
| Rotten                                                                                                                                      | Damp-Heat in Large Intestine (may be ulcerative colitis) |
| Fishy                                                                                                                                       | Phlegm-Heat in Lung                                      |
| SWEAT                                                                                                                                       |                                                          |
| Sweat's smell is related to Dampness — fluids forming sweat come from the space between skin and muscles, where Dampness often accumulates. |                                                          |
| Strong-smelling                                                                                                                             | Damp-Heat                                                |
| Putrid-smelling                                                                                                                             | Disease of the Lungs, Liver, or Kidneys                  |
| SPUTUM                                                                                                                                      |                                                          |
| Strong-smelling, often rotten                                                                                                               | Heat in the Lungs — usually Phlegm-Heat or Toxic Heat    |
| Fishy-smelling                                                                                                                              | Lung-Heat                                                |
| Without smell                                                                                                                               | Cold                                                     |
| STOOL & FLATULENCE                                                                                                                          |                                                          |
| Extremely stinky, foul, diarrhea + pus/blood                                                                                                | Damp-Heat in the Intestines                              |
| Sour + foul + indigestion                                                                                                                   | Food stagnation                                          |
| Fishy odor + loose stools                                                                                                                   | Cold in Spleen/Stomach                                   |
| Slight/odorless flatulence, aggravated by emotional stress                                                                                  | Liver-Qi stagnation                                      |
| Flatulence rancid, rotten like rotten eggs                                                                                                  | Toxic Heat in the Large Intestines                       |
| Abnormal stool color, but without odor / frequent odorless flatulence                                                                       | Stomach/LI-Qi deficiency                                 |
| URINE                                                                                                                                       |                                                          |
| Frequent, urgent, painful, burning, turbid yellow + foul odor                                                                               | Damp-Heat in Bladder                                     |
| Heavy smell of urea, scanty yellow urine                                                                                                    | Heart-Fire pouring into Bladder                          |
| Clear, frequent, odorless (or slightly fishy)                                                                                               | Kidney deficiency                                        |
| Odorless urinary incontinence                                                                                                               | Exhaustion of Kidney-Fire                                |
| VAGINAL DISCHARGE & NOSE/EARS/EYES ODORS                                                                                                    |                                                          |
| Strong, leathery vaginal discharge                                                                                                          | Damp-Heat                                                |
| Fishy vaginal discharge                                                                                                                     | Damp-Cold                                                |
| Strong-smelling lochia (post-childbirth)                                                                                                    | Damp-Heat or Toxic Heat in the Uterus                    |
| Nose: yellow sticky discharge, foul odor                                                                                                    | Heat in Lung, or Damp-Heat in Spleen/Stomach             |
| Ears: foul, fishy odor + turbid pus/discharge                                                                                               | Damp-Heat in the ear                                     |
| Eyes: red/swollen + turbid tears + foul/fishy odor or ulceration                                                                            | Damp-Heat in the Liver channel                           |

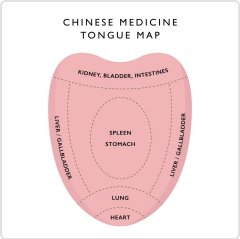
|              |                  |             |
|--------------|------------------|-------------|
| PATTERN NAME | DISEASE CATEGORY | WEEK / QUIZ |
|              |                  |             |

|          |              |      |
|----------|--------------|------|
| ETIOLOGY | ORGAN SYSTEM | DATE |
|          |              |      |

CLINICAL ESSENTIALS — CASE NOTES

HEARING & SMELLING 聞診

CHINESE MEDICINE TONGUE MAP



VOICE / BREATH / SOUND / ODOR

PULSE 脈診 · CUN · GUAN · CHI

|            |       |        |       |
|------------|-------|--------|-------|
| Wrist      | CUN 寸 | GUAN 關 | CHI 尺 |
| L<br>HT/SI |       | LV/GB  | KD/BL |
| R<br>LU/LI |       | SP/ST  | PC/TB |

QUALITY / OVERALL

TREATMENT PRINCIPLE 治則

KEY POINTS / HERBS

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